

Max points 25 (content 10, grammar 5, vocabulary and register 5, coherence 5)

16 1/4 db (3)

- Discuss the importance of committed relationships in *About a Boy*

Nick Hornby, coming from

Write an essay of 280–300 words on the basis of the text *About a Boy* by Nick Hornby. Do not write about the text and/or the author in general.

Fiona – Clive:

Marcus says „My life is shit.“ His dad is a shit/dad. Fiona tries to kill herself.

Will: a typical lad – as he grew up, he figured out the importance of relationships.

Rachel:

He not a good liar. He an ^{passionate} enthusiastic liar. → Lies in a relationship have led them to the whole Fiona situation

~~Marissa~~

Bildungsroman

IMPORTANCE OF COMMITTED RELATIONSHIPS IN ABOUT A BOY

Mitja
Severkan
3. A

Nick Hornby, coming from a ^{separated} divorced family himself, often writes about family dynamics and relationships in his stories, such as Ball Fever and About a Boy. ^{some reference} There we can observe various relationships, most prominent of them being between Fiona and Clive, as well as Will and Rachel. Committed relationships are highly important, despite not being as featured.?

~~Firstly~~ ^{it would be better to introduce you're analyzing like topic sentence not an example} For example, Fiona and Clive's relationship has never been committed, despite them not really hating themselves, as can be observed from ^{Fiona's} the Christmas party ~~invitation~~ invitation (from Fiona) to Clive. However, this ^{lack of involvement} uninvolved and neutral relationship has caused harm to Marcus, who grew up practically without a dad and under Fiona's strict influence, precisely due to ~~parents'~~ ^{non-involvement} uninvolved with each other and to a certain point Marcus. ~~As can be seen~~ Furthermore, as Marcus resists? Ellie, stating how his life is "shit", and later on saying how Clive is a "shit dad" and ^{how} he lives with a mother who tried killing herself, it's clear that none of this would have ^{how do we ~~would~~ know?} happened if Fiona and Clive ^{pragmatically} (would have) lived together, or at least were both more involved and committed to themselves and Marcus.

Moreover, Will, who ~~used~~ ^{was} to live in his bubble, not wanting or needing to grow up mentally, has had previous relationships, which did not go according to his plans; ^{run-on} often full of lies.

[Will only has a committed relationship, with which he feels satisfied, only when he stops lying. This can be mostly

gr It is only when W. stops lying that he is able to form...

^{How so? What makes that?}
~~inferred~~ ^{gr} inferred from his relationship with Rachel. As Will grows ^{up} as a person, he finds out that something that money can't buy, is missing from him - that is a relationship, to which he commits. ~~As many would say lies never cause anything~~ feeling the need to be loved and to take care of ~~and~~ and be taken care of. ^{This can be observed when} As an example, once he figures ^{regrets} out that ^{do not contribute to a solid relationship} lies are not good and have led him to his involvement with Marcus, Fiona and such, ^{so} he decides to come clean to Rachel, saying that Marcus isn't his child, declaring his moral growth, ~~and~~ commitment to change and to ~~be~~ ^{their} relationship.

^{gr (Lies were attempted but not done correctly)} Not only that committed relationships contribute ^{or would contribute} to Will's and Marcus' wellbeing and their development in this Bildungsroman, ~~they contribute to the whole story plot,~~ many readers could ^{irrelevant} recognize themselves in such ^{distant} ~~uncommitted~~ relationships, therefore considering a change. In conclusion, strong ^{bond} ~~relationships~~ between characters are of the utmost importance in *About a Boy*.

C	5-6
G	3-4
V	1
O	3-4